

Figure 1: Default UI of aptitude

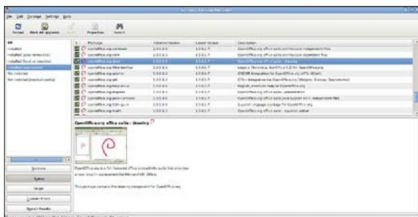


Figure 2: The Synaptic package manager

```
apt-get remove package_name
```

By default, apt-get will not remove any configuration file for your package (to make the upgrade smooth). If you want to remove configuration files, issue the following command:

```
apt-get --purge remove package_name
```

Update for good

I'm sure you would always want to keep your system updated just so that you're in sync with the latest features, as well as security updates:

```
apt-get update
```

```
apt-get upgrade # download & install the updates
```

If you want to upgrade your system to a newer Debian release (for example, from Etch to Lenny, or stable Lenny to unstable Sid), use the following command:

```
apt-get dist-upgrade
```

Of course, don't forget to do an *apt-get update* before the distribution upgrade.

Advanced package management

Sometimes, you might want to play with packages, and want all build dependencies of packages in one shot:

```
apt-get build-dep package_name
```

You might also want to download the source of the Debian package:

```
apt-get source package_name
```

If you are a developer, and want to check out the development repository of a Debian package, you have a nice command called *debcheckout*. Make sure that you have the *devscripts* package installed for this.

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